

DAY 8

Sprint Planning: Running the Ceremony

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the purpose and structure of Sprint Planning
- Learn how to facilitate a Sprint Planning session as a PM or Scrum Master
- Understand sprint capacity planning: how to know how much work a team can take
- Learn how to write a sprint goal that is specific, outcome-focused, and shared by the whole team
- **YouTube Search Terms:**
 - "Sprint planning meeting tutorial"
 - "How to run sprint planning as a scrum master"
 - "Sprint capacity planning"
 - "Writing a good sprint goal"
- **Recommended Channels:**
 - Atlassian
 - Agile Alliance
 - PM Majik

Tasks:

- Study **sprint capacity planning** in detail — understand **velocity** (how many story points a team completes per sprint), **how to calculate team capacity in hours**, and **how to use both to decide how much work fits in a sprint**
- Learn the **two parts of Sprint Planning** — **Part 1 is What will be done** (selecting backlog items) and **Part 2 is How will it be done** (breaking stories into tasks) — understand why both parts are necessary
- Write a **Sprint Planning agenda** document — a step-by-step facilitation guide that a PM could use to run a **real 2-hour Sprint Planning session for a team of 5**, including questions to ask and outputs to capture
- In your Jira project, run a simulated Sprint Planning — calculate a fake team capacity of 40 story points, select stories from the backlog that fit within that capacity, and write a sprint goal for Sprint 1

Deliverable

- Sprint Planning facilitation guide
- Jira Sprint 1 with stories selected, capacity documented, and sprint goal written
- Short note: what happens when teams over-commit in sprint planning and how to prevent it

→Sprint Capacity Planning

Velocity: Velocity is the average number of story points a team completes in a sprint.

Example

Sprint	Completed Story Points
Sprint 1	38
Sprint 2	42
Sprint 3	40

Average Velocity: $(38+42+40)/3 = 40$

Team Velocity = 40 Story Points

This means the team can usually complete around 40 story points every sprint.

Team Capacity: Capacity measures how many working hours are available during the sprint.

Formula : Team Capacity = Team Members × Working Days × Hours Per Day

Example

Team Member	Available Hours
Dev 1	32
Dev 2	32
Dev 3	32
QA	32
Designer	32

Total Capacity: $32 + 32 + 32 + 32 + 32 = 160$ Hours

Using Velocity and Capacity Together

1. Velocity tells us **how much work** the team usually completes.
2. Capacity tells us **how much time** the team actually has available.
3. Both should be checked before selecting sprint work.

Example

- Historical Velocity = 40 Story Points
- Current Sprint Capacity = Normal

Result:

- The team can likely commit to around 40 Story Points.

If several team members are on leave:

- Capacity decreases
 - Sprint commitment should be reduced
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→ Two Parts of Sprint Planning

Part 1 – What Will Be Done? The team: • Reviews Product Backlog • Understands priorities • Discusses requirements • Selects stories for the sprint • Creates Sprint Goal Output • Sprint Goal • Selected User Stories	Part 2 – How Will It Be Done? The team: • Breaks stories into tasks • Identifies dependencies • Discusses technical approach • Estimates task effort Output • Sprint Backlog • Task Breakdown • Initial ownership discussions
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→ Sprint Planning Facilitation Guide (2-Hour Session)

Team Size: 5 Members

Duration: 2 Hours

Time	Activity
0–10 min	Meeting Introduction
10–40 min	Review Sprint Goal & Priorities
40–80 min	Select User Stories
80–110 min	Break Stories into Tasks
110–120 min	Confirm Commitment & Close

Step 1: Introduction (10 Minutes)

Facilitator Questions

- What is the objective of this sprint?
- Are there any team absences?
- What is our available capacity?

Output

- Capacity confirmed
- Sprint objective understood

Step 2: Review Prioritized Backlog (30 Minutes)

Facilitator Questions

- Which items provide the highest value?
- Are requirements clear?
- Are acceptance criteria defined?

Output

- Prioritized candidate stories

Step 3: Select Stories (40 Minutes)

Facilitator Questions

- Does this story support the sprint goal?
- Do we understand the requirements?
- Can this fit within capacity?

Output

- Stories selected
- Story point total confirmed

Step 4: Break Stories into Tasks (30 Minutes)

Facilitator Questions

- What development tasks are required?
- What testing tasks are needed?
- Are there dependencies?

Output

- Sprint Backlog
- Task breakdown completed

Step 5: Final Review (10 Minutes)

Facilitator Questions

- Is everyone comfortable with the commitment?
- Does the sprint goal still make sense?
- Are risks identified?

Output

- Sprint Goal finalized
 - Sprint commitment confirmed
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→Jira Sprint 1 (Simulated)

Team Capacity

Metric	Value
Team Size	5
Velocity	40 Story Points
Sprint Capacity	40 Story Points

Selected Stories

Story ID	Tasks To Implement	Story Points
ETA-14	User Registration	8
ETA-17	User Login, Password Recovery, Dashboard	13
ETA-18	Add Expense	8
ETA-20	Edit Expenses	5
ETA-21	Delete Expense	3
ETA-25	View Expense History	3

ETA Sprint 1 16 Jun – 2 Jul (13 work items)				40	0	0	Start sprint	...
ETA-14	As a user, I want to create an account so that my data is saved securely.	USER AUTHENTICATI...	IDEA	8	↑	↓	👤	
ETA-4	User Registration	USER AUTHENTICATI...	IDEA	-	↑	↓	👤	
ETA-17	As a user, I want to log in so that I can access my expense records.	USER AUTHENTICATI...	IDEA	13	↑	↓	👤	
ETA-5	User Login	USER AUTHENTICATI...	IDEA	-	↑	↓	👤	
ETA-6	Password Recovery	USER AUTHENTICATI...	IDEA	0	↑	↓	👤	
ETA-18	As a user, I want to add an expense so that I can track my spending.	EXPENSE MANAGEME...	IDEA	5	↑	↓	👤	
ETA-7	Add Expense	EXPENSE MANAGEME...	IDEA	-	↑	↓	👤	
ETA-20	As a user, I want to edit expenses so that I can correct mistakes.	EXPENSE MANAGEME...	IDEA	8	=	↓	👤	
ETA-8	Edit Expense		IDEA	-	=	↓	👤	
ETA-21	As a user, I want to delete expenses so that I can remove incorrect entries.	EXPENSE MANAGEME...	IDEA	3	=	↓	👤	
ETA-9	Delete Expense		IDEA	-	=	↓	👤	
ETA-25	As a user, I want to search expenses so that I can quickly find transactions.	REPORTS & ANALYTICS	IDEA	3	↓	↓	👤	
ETA-10	View Expense History	REPORTS & ANALYTICS	IDEA	-	=	↓	👤	

Total: 8+5+13+8+3+3 = 40 Story Points

Sprint Goal: Enable users to create accounts, log in securely, record expenses, view expense history, edit expenses, and see a basic expense dashboard.

→ What Happens When Teams Over-Commit?

Over-commitment occurs when teams select more work than they can realistically complete within the sprint.

Problems Caused

- Missed sprint goals
- Unfinished stories
- Increased stress
- Reduced product quality
- Loss of stakeholder confidence

How to Prevent Over-Commitment

1. Use historical velocity for planning.
2. Consider team availability and leave.
3. Break large stories into smaller stories.
4. Keep a buffer for unexpected work.
5. Focus on sprint goal rather than maximizing workload.
6. Allow the development team to decide how much work they can commit to.

Key Principle: Commit based on evidence (velocity and capacity), not optimism. This leads to predictable and successful sprint delivery.